## EVOLUTION OF THE STUDY OF IR

The First World War resulted in unparalleled destruction and devastation of almost every country involved, with millions of lives lost—perhaps a proper estimate can never be done. Total economic collapse, widespread famine, and rampant disease continued to add to the death toll, many years after the fighting had ended, even for the winning side, the victorious nations. It is from this awesome and traumatic experience of the First World War that the inspiration to study IR, as a separate academic discipline, grew.

The origin of IR can be traced to the writings of political philosophers such as, Thucydides, an ancient Greek historian who wrote the *History of the Peloponnesian War* and is also cited as an intellectual forerunner of *realpolitik*, Chanakya's *Arthashastra,* and Niccolò Machiavelli's *Il Principe* (*The Prince).* However, IR as an academic discipline in its own right only came to be studied after the horrifying experiences of the First World War. Before that, IR had always existed as a branch of history, law, philosophy, political science and other related subjects. But World War I, resulting in a loss of 20 million lives, proved the bankruptcy and limitations of traditional European diplomacy as a method of maintaining world order, and there grew an urge for alternatives.

This gave birth to the liberal approaches to IR which is often collectively referred to as *idealism* or sometimes as *utopianism*. Their focus was on the ills of international system, and, "what ought to be done" to avoid major disasters in the future and to save the future generations from the scourge of wars. There were many strands of liberal thinking, but the basic assumption, running throughout the many liberal writings, was that human beings were rational and, when they apply reason to international relations, they can set up organizations for the benefit of all. Therefore, emphasis was laid on outlawing war, disarmament, international law and international organizations during this phase of evolution of liberal thinking. The chief advocates of post-World War I (WWI) idealism were Alfred Zimmern (1879–1957), Norman Angell (1872–1967), James T. Shotwell (1874–1965), and Woodrow Wilson (1856–1924). In particular, Wilson's "14 Points" speech, delivered before the US